

Living in Bloomington Guide

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Pre-arrival Guide - What to Pack?

While packing for your first travel to the USA, you should keep the following in mind

Luggages/ Backpack

- Carefully follow your itinerary policies to see how many luggages you are allowed to bring for free.
- For checked in luggages, 28" luggages are the biggest ones to satisfy the airlines policies (for economy class).
- Try to buy good quality polyester luggages as they are lightweight. It will help you pack 2-3 lbs more than fabric luggages.
- Make sure the luggages have four spinning wheels. These wheels make it easier to stroll the luggages in the airport.
- Bring a backpack to carry laptop and documents. You can carry the backpack as your carry on bag. Never leave your important documents or expensive stuffs such as laptop in the checked in luggage as some airports have reports of theft from check-in luggages. Besides, you can use the backpack to classes and labs.
- Some airlines allow the passenger to carry a small carry on luggage with them. Check your airlines itinerary if you are allowed to carry one.

Liquid stuffs

- Try to avoid liquids such as oil, shampoo, or other cosmetics or kitchen stuffs. You can buy them here at Walmart or Kroger at a cheaper price. Moreover, the luggages endure

huge pressure in the flight storages which risks the liquids to burst and make a mess in the luggage.

- If you really need to bring liquid, seal the container firmly to avoid any burst or leakage. Put any liquid product you don't need urgently to your check-in baggages (large baggages which you leave at the counter while checking in). There is a limit of liquid you can carry while you fly. You can see the rules [here](#).

Clothes/Shoes

- Bring enough formal/ casual/ comfortable/ home clothes and underwares with you so that you don't have to purchase clothes for at least six months. Clothes are in general expensive in USA although the fabric quality is good.
- For the fall and summer, bring comfortable clothes as the weather can get hot and humid in times. The last part of fall gets colder, so you may need full sleeve tshirts or pants.
- You will need heavy jackets, innerwares and heavy socks for winter. But you will get enough time to buy them here. Besides, quality of the winter clothes is important, hence it's better not to bring them with you. BISM arranges a winter shopping trip on the last week of October which is very helpful for winter cloth shopping.
- Shoes are also expensive here. So, it's better if you can bring formal, casual, and comfortable shoes. You may have to walk a lot in the campus. Running/walking shoes will keep you comfortable in those cases.
- You may want to attend career fairs and interviews several times. Keep at least one set of formal clothing for these events.
- Bring a towel and a bedsheet for first few days before you go shopping.
- Keep a light hooded sweatshirt or jacket while you fly. It'll keep you warm if the plane is very cold. Also, classes and labs may turn out to be very cold in the summer because of air conditioning. The hooded jacket may be helpful in those cases.

Medicine/ Spectacles

- Bring any urgent medicine you are prescribed to take regularly with you. If possible, keep the prescription with you in case the customs ask you about the medicine.
- You can keep some basic first aid medicine with you for emergencies such as headache, gastric, cold, etc.
- If you wear spectacles, bring at least two or three powered extra spectacles as they are expensive here. If you wear powered shades, bring two or three of them as well. If you suspect you may lose/ break your glasses often, you can bring more.

Kitchen Utensils

- You may buy almost all the kitchen utensils and glasswares here in the dollar stores (where each product can be bought for \$1.25). Still for surviving the first couple of days in USA before you go shopping, you can bring one set of plate, mug/glass, spoon, fork, knife, etc.

- Bring a scissor in the luggage if possible. It'll be helpful to unpack and settle in your apartment. Please keep in mind that scissors or sharp stuffs are not allowed in carry ons. You have to pack them in the checked luggage.
- There is an indian grocery shop (Apna Bazaar) and several chinese grocery shops (Btown Market, Rong cheng) in Bloomington. They sell a rich variety of asian and indian spices and grocery products. So, you don't need to bring any kitchen spices or oil with you. But you can pack a very little amount of spices as you may need to wait some days before shopping all these. Also, the products in these shops are a bit expensive. So, there is no harm in bringing some kitchen products yourselves. Please seal any kind of liquid to avoid spill/burst.

Miscellaneous

- Make sure you carry your passport, i20 and admission offer letter with you. you'll have to show them in the immigration counter.
- After immigration is completed, the customs may ask to scan your luggage for restricted items. You cannot bring [these](#) items either in carry on or in the checked in luggages.

Getting to Bloomington

Reaching Bloomington from:

- **Indianapolis -**
 - The most popular shuttle from Indianapolis airport to Bloomington, [GoExpress](#) operates daily from 8:40 am to 10:40 pm. They charge \$29/person and allows two free luggages.
 - If you have another person with you to travel to Bloomington, you can take Uber/Lyft. Riding uber/ lyft alone is also an option, but that would cost you a lot depending on the time of the day and ride demand (~\$65-\$120). With carpooling, you'd like to keep the luggage count in your consideration as well. In general, a sedan car can carry no more than 2 large luggages. a minivan/SUV would be able to carry 6 large luggages at most. you should check the car capacity before adding more people.
 - BISM will provide rides to the incoming students daily from August 1st to August 15, 2026. You can request a ride [here](#).(<https://iubism.org>)
 - If you arrive late and miss all the above-mentioned options, you can still rent a hotel near the airport and take the first GoExpress shuttle the next day (8:40 am). Make sure you book a hotel with free airport shuttle service. You can find a convenient hotel here (<https://www.ind.com/transportation-car-rental/hotel-courtesy-vehicles>). Another option is to stay at the airport at night and wait till the first shuttle next morning. It may be an option if you want to save the hotel money. Please keep in mind that the airport does not provide sleeping amenities. But the airport is a safe and secured place for a night stay.
 - You can post an ad to [IU classifieds](#) seeking a ride to Bloomington from Indianapolis airport. It might not be a very convenient option as you may not have a sim card with

you (although the airport has free wifi) and contacting the rider might be difficult. Also, there is a facebook [group](#) where you can request for a ride.

- **Chicago** - O'Hare airport has free public wifi. Use the wifi for surfing google maps or communicating with uber/lyft.
 - [Greyhound bus service](#): You can buy a ticket from the bus stop (fare varies from \$40-\$60). The closest greyhound bus stop from the airport is 5800 N Cumberland Ave, Chicago, IL 60631. You can either take uber/lyft to go to the bus stop or take the city shuttles. If you want to ride the city shuttles, carry cash usd (changes such as \$5 or \$1 bills) with you. Also, follow google maps to determine which shuttle to hop on. Another thing to keep in mind is, the Greyhound bus stations are not the safest places and people who are traveling alone and look to be out of town can be vulnerable. It's better to travel as a group using Greyhound buses.
 - Another option is taking a uber/lyft and directly traveling to Bloomington. This option might be very expensive. And keep the luggage capacity of the car in consideration before booking a ride.
 - If any of the above mentioned options does not work for you, you can still book a flight to Indianapolis airport and follow the above mentioned tips to get to Bloomington from Indianapolis airport.

Note: You may not have a active sim card when you arrive to the USA and Bloomington for the first time. You can [download](#) the map of relevant places (Chicago, Indianapolis, Bloomington) from google maps offline before you fly. These offline maps will be helpful for you to navigate when you don't have internet. In addition, the airports have public free wifi.

Cultural and Social Amenities

Groceries

- **Bloomingfoods (Bloomington's Co-op) East and West** (<https://www.bloomingfoods.coop/>): Mid-sized store that carries higher-end products with a lot of specialty items. Also has a food bar, deli, and baked goods.
- **Bloomington Community Farmers' Market** (<https://bloomington.in.gov/farmers-market>): Held Saturdays from April to November, here is a terrific way to get local fresh produce and other offerings from area farmers and other vendors and producers.
- **Woolery Farmer's Market @ Woolery Mill**: 2250 W. Sunstone Drive, Bloomington, IN 47403 8:00 AM to 12:00 PM.
- **Apna Bazaar** (<https://apna-bazaar-international-market.business.site/>): One of the most renowned and trusted brands when it comes to Indian and ethnic groceries.
- **B-Town International Market** (<https://www.facebook.com/btowninternationalmarket/>): Wide selection of various Asian ingredients.

- **4th Street International Market** (Address: 408 E 4th St, Bloomington, IN 47408): Maintains collection of international groceries - specially middle eastern and south asian groceries.
- **World Food Market** (<https://www.worldfoods-market.com/>): Probably has the widest variety of international groceries. One unique feature is that they have bulk sections of international groceries which other international grocery stores do not have.
- **Butcher's Block** (<https://bloomingtonmeat.com/>): Dedicated meat and seafood store. Maintains a wide collection of fresh meats and seafood.
- **Kroger** (<https://www.kroger.com/>): Large supermarket chain that offers a wide selection of fresh and dry goods. (Offline store as well as online).
- **Aldi** (<https://www.aldi.us/>): Discount grocery store with a limited selection of items, but priced very reasonably.
- **Fresh Thyme** (<https://www.freshthyme.com/>): Higher-end grocery store that carries a lot of specialty items. Has a wide selection of dairy, meats, grains, fresh produce and a bakery.
- **Target** (<https://www.target.com/>): Limited selection of fresh produce, but has some specialty snacks and drinks not available at other stores.
- **Walmart** (<https://www.walmart.com/>): Large supermarket chain that offers a wide selection of fresh and dry goods.

Bakeries

- **Two Sticks Bakery** (<https://www.twosticksbakery.com/>): The most popular, consistently voted the best.
- **Baked! Of Bloomington** (<http://www.bakedofbloomington.com/>): Custom made fresh cookie with vegan and gluten-free options.
- **Rainbow Bakery** (<http://rainbowbakery.net/>): Vegan bakery with gluten-free options.
- **Muddy Fork Bakery** <http://muddyforkbakery.com/>: Local bakery that offers high-quality artisanal breads and pastries. Available at Saturday's farmer's market or Bloomingfoods East and West.
- **Scholar's Inn Bakery** (<https://www.scholarsinnbakehouse.com/>): Many items are available at local grocery stores as well.
- **Feast**: <https://feastoften.com/>
- **Blu Boy Chocolate Cafe & Cakery**
- **Piccoli Dolci**: <https://piccoli-dolci.squarespace.com/>: At the Woolery Farmer's market.

Groceries with Online Delivery

- **Instacart**: Delivery from CVS, Kroger, Aldi and Target, Staples, Fresh Thyme. It is paid but when you register, it gives 14 day free access to its premium account.
- **GoPuff**: Offers quick delivery within 1/2 hours for a slightly higher delivery fee
- **Kroger**: Offers free in-store pickup and shipping (\$35 minimum purchase). Delivery fee applies: \$9.95.
- **Walmart**: Delivery fee and/or express fee may apply. \$35 minimum order.

- [Aldi](#): Offers 2-hour delivery and in-store pickup. Delivery fees apply around \$4.00.
- [Sam's Club](#): Requires membership. Free shipping on most items and does not require minimum purchase.

Dining Options in Bloomington

There are many dining options in Bloomington and here we just provide a provisional list of some of the more popular places. We encourage you to explore Restaurant Row on 4th street for a variety of restaurants that serve international cuisines. Bloomington also has several chain restaurants like Olive Garden, Chili's, Fazoli's etc. in the College Mall area.

- **Restaurant row**: Restaurants located in Bloomington's historic district on 4th street: https://www.magbloom.com/dining-out-towns/restaurant_row/
- **The Owlery**: vegetarian restaurant bar with vegan options and awesome brunch: <https://theowleryrestaurant.com/>
- **The Laughing Planet**: local favorite with vegetarian, vegan, and gluten-free options: https://www.thelaughingplanetcafe.com/?page_id=8
- **Bucceto's Smiling Teeth**: pizza place with wide gluten-free menu: <https://buccetos.com/>
- **Goodfellas Pizzeria**: popular for their large and delicious 22" pizza. <https://www.goodfellaspizzeria.com>
- **Turkuaz Cafe**: Mediterranean, Turkish cuisine. Address: 301 E 3rd St, Bloomington, IN 47401
- **Samira Restaurant**: Mediterranean, Middle Eastern, Afghan cuisine. Address: 100 W 6th St, Bloomington, IN 47404. Website: <https://samirasrestaurant.four-food.com/>
- **Anatolia Restaurant**: Mediterranean, Turkish cuisine. Address: 405 E 4th St, Bloomington, IN 47408. Website: <http://www.restaurantanatolia.com/>
- **Hibachi Buffet**: Best Chinese buffet with a really wide array of options. <http://mrhibachibuffet.com/>
- **The Amrit India**: Great and tasty buffet. <http://amritindiarestaurant.com/>
- **The Taste of India**: Authentic Indian cuisine. <http://www.tasteofindiabtown.com/>
- **Mama's Restaurant Korean BBQ**: - authentic Korean cuisine. <https://www.allmenus.com/in/bloomington/24800-mamas-korean-bbq-restaurant/menu/>

Halal Groceries and Restaurants

A lot of muslim students follow religious dietary restriction of foods being halal, especially meats. Following are the grocery stores that keep halal meats and restaurants that serve halal food. Detailed information about these places are discussed in previous sections.

- **4th Street International Market**: Keeps frozen halal meat. Probably the cheapest place to get halal meat in Bloomington. They also supply items to Apna Bazar.
- **Apna Bazaar**: Keeps frozen halal meat. <https://apna-bazaar-international-market.business.site/>

- **Butchers Block:** Keep frozen halal chicken. For fresh halal chicken they require order in advance. Can also manage halal lamb if requested in advance. Little expensive compared to 4th street international market. Website: <https://bloomingtonmeat.com/smokehouse/>
- **Turkuaz Cafe**
- **Samira Restaurant:** <https://samirasrestaurant.four-food.com/>
- **Anatolia Restaurant:** www.restaurantanatolia.com
- **Test of India:** www.tasteofindiabtown.com

Restaurants and Delivery Services

- [Btown Menus](#)
- [Doordash](#)
- [Grubhub](#)
- [Postmates](#)
- [Hooked](#)

Food systems map in Bloomington:

https://www.google.com/maps/d/u/0/viewer?mid=1T8y2QBB_WprQ7fQgt-XtNZLbXNsRtDc&ll=39.29288507837276%2C-86.63017150440658&z=12

Housing Options

Housing Guide

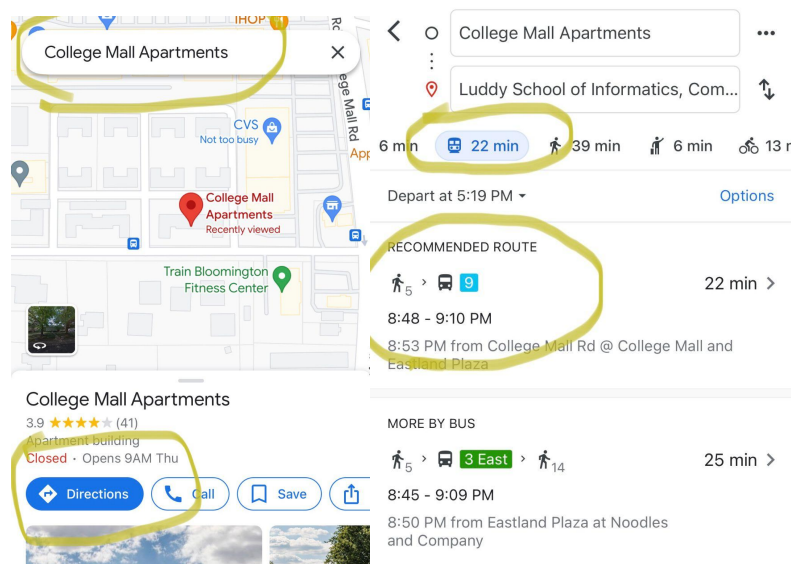
- [IU Graduate and Professional Student Government Housing Guide](#)
- [IU Real Estate](#)
- [Apartment Guide](#)
- [IU Classifieds](#)
- [IDS News Housing Guide](#)
- [Apartments in Bloomington Guide](#)
- [Hoosier Apartments](#)
- [Rentable](#) - Bloomington
- [Craigslist](#) - Bloomington
- Hoosier Times Classifieds: <https://classified.gatehousemedia.com/adhunter/hoosiertimes/>
- Info from OIS: <https://ois.iu.edu/living-in-the-us/housing/index.html>

Selecting a suitable apartment

You want to keep a few things in mind while you search for a suitable apartment.

- **Rent:** Check if the rent mentioned in the apartment site is the total rent of the apartment or the rent per person
- **Amenities:** If the apartment has accessible laundry options

- Location: Perhaps the most important thing to consider after rent. The apartment should not be very far (not more than 10 min walk) from the nearest suitable bus stop as it gets difficult in the winter to walk in the cold weather. You should consider the bus routes to your workplace and the grocery store. You can use the google maps to easily check these things from any place even if you are not in Bloomington. Here is a visual demonstration of the process.



1. Look for the apartment in google maps and select “direction”
2. Select “Luddy hall” or a grocery store (typically “kroger”, “aldi” or “target”) in the destination or source
3. Select the “commute” button (marked in the screenshot) and check how far walk is the bus stop from your apartment.

Popular Housing Options

- Fountain Park Apartments: <https://www.fountainpark-aps.com/>
- Woodbridge Apartments: <https://www.woodbridgeapt.com/>
- Meadow Park Apartments: <https://www.meadowpark-aps.com/>
- Cedargate Apartments: <https://www.cedargatebloomblyon.com/>
- Scholar’s Quad Collegiate Apartments: <https://www.housing.indiana.edu/housing/cancellation/index.htmlw.scholarsquad.com/>
- Bloomington Student Apartments: <https://www.iuapartmentsbloomington.com/>
- Crescent Park Apartments: <https://www.distinctmanagement.com/crescent-park>
- Park Doral apartments <https://www.apartmentguide.com/apartments/Indiana/Bloomington/Park-Doral/42789/>
- College mall apartments <https://deerparkmgmt.com/college-mall/>
- The monroe <https://themonroeliving.com/>
- Hunter Ridge <https://www.apartmentguide.com/apartments/Indiana/Bloomington/Hunter-Ridge/45124/>
- Northcrest apartments <https://www.northcrest-aps.com/>

- **Notes**

- Off campus housing rent generally do not include electricity and internet fees, so you have to pay these utility bills alongside rent. Some apartments charge water, gas or trash fees as well.

On Campus Housing

- [Campus View](#)
- [Tulip Tree](#)
- <https://www.rps.indiana.edu/Contact/index.htm>
- **Notes**
 - On-campus housing rent includes all utilities (internet, electricity, water, trash, etc). So, you only pay the rent.

Roommates/Sublets

- [Indiana University \(IU\) Housing, Sublets & Roommates](#)
- [Indiana University \(IU\) Housing, Rooms, Apartments, Sublets](#)
- [Bloomington Cooperative](#)
- One.IU -> IU Classifieds: <https://one.iu.edu/launch-task/iu/classifieds?terms=IU%20classifieds>
- Indiana Daily Student Classified Ads: <http://guides.idsnews.com/classifieds>

Temporary Stays

You have several options to manage your temporary stay at that time.

- You can rent a motel/ hotel if you are alone. Or you can rent an Airbnb if you have a group. This option will be expensive given the rush in Bloomington at that time.
- You can post an ad to [IU Classifieds](#) asking for a stay mentioning the timeline. You can offer some money to the person letting you stay at that time as a courtesy. In general, students in Bloomington are very friendly and they help incoming students in these cases.
- You can email [BISM](#) mentioning your situation in detail. It's a volunteer group that tends to help the incoming students a lot.

Rental Insurance

- <https://www.consumeraffairs.com/insurance/renters-insurance/#guide-features>

Lease Signing

Questions to Ask Before Signing an Apartment Lease:

Before you sign a contract for a housing rental, be sure you understand all of the terms in the contract. Do not be afraid to ask if you have any questions or are unsure of something in the contract.

Lease fine-print

1. Are there any application fees?
2. Are there any move-in or holding fees? Are they refundable if I don't secure a property?
(Will money be refunded if it turns out no units are available?)
3. How much is the security deposit? How much of the deposit is returned at the end of the lease? What will prevent me from getting my security deposit back?
4. When is rent due?
5. How long is the lease?
6. After the initial term of the lease, will I need to renew for a year or will I be able to lease month to month?
7. Are there penalties for late payments? What are the penalties for late payments?
8. Is subletting allowed? What are the lease breaking fees?

Utilities

9. What utilities are included in the rent? (water, trash, internet, tv cable, gas and electricity)
10. Is the internet, wireless or wi-fi available? For a fee? Paid by whom?
11. What is the approximate cost for utilities that are not included in the rent?
12. Are there any costs for setting up the utilities that are not covered in the rent? Who do I need to contact to set up utilities that are not covered in the rent?
13. How big is the hot water heater and is the hot water heater shared with any other apartments?
(This is a relatively important question, if there is a small heater, or if there is one shared with your neighbor who likes to take hour-long showers right before you have to get up, you may end up taking cold showers more often than you'd like.)

Parking/Other Amenities

14. Where is the parking area?
15. Is parking included in the rent or are there any additional parking fees?
16. Is there a pool? Can it be used by anyone? Are there any additional fees for using the pool or gym area?

Maintenance

17. What happens if I accidentally break an appliance?
18. How is routine maintenance completed for the unit? Are maintenance people on call 24 hours a day? If not, who should you call if there is an emergency?
19. Am I allowed to paint the walls?
20. Am I allowed to hang pictures with nails?

Modifying Lease terms

21. Am I allowed to have overnight guests?
22. What are the procedures if I decide to have a roommate at a later time?

Other

23. Do you require renters insurance?
24. Are there any noise level restrictions?
25. Where are the smoke detectors and do they work?
26. If there is not an in-unit washer and dryer, where is the laundry and what is the cost?
27. Can you get cell phone reception inside the apartment? Watch for metal roofs - might be able to get an amplifier.
28. Am I allowed to have pets? If I don't have one now, and I get one at a later date, will my lease change?
29. Is the complex on the bus line? It is also important to find out if the apartment is on the city or campus bus line. If the apartment is on the city bus line, find out if the bus stops near the Informatics Building (10th Street and Woodlawn). Some bus routes go to other areas of Bloomington so you would need to allow more time in your daily travel. An apartment on the campus shuttle is most convenient because the shuttle stops directly in front of Informatics buildings. Bloomington. Transit route information is available online at www.bloomingtontransit.com. Use the DoubleMap app to find the live location of buses. It is extremely useful!
30. Be sure you know what is furnished and what is not furnished before signing a lease.

Legal Services

- You can ask IU student legal services to look over your lease if you are uncertain about any of the terms and conditions. <https://studentaffairs.indiana.edu/student-support/legal-services/housing-leases/managing-your-lease-during-covid-19.html>
- You can also reach out to the Department of Housing and Neighborhood Development (HAND) for help. More information can be found in this link - <https://bloomington.in.gov/housing/rental-complaints>.

Household Furnishings

Second Hand Options

- Take advantage of Hoosier to Hoosier Sell (usually in late August) <http://sustain.iu.edu/programs/hoosier-to-hoosier/about-h2h.php>
- International Students should register for International Furniture Give-a-way <http://www.myfga.org/>
- Goodwill: Consider buying basic appliances or other household furnishing at discount stores such as Goodwill instead of buying brand new.

- Search IU Classifieds for used household furnishings: One.IU > IU Classifieds
- [Bloomington International Student Ministries](#) (BISM, local church).
- [IU Surplus Store](#): The merchandise is constantly changing, but there's always something interesting, which IU departments are repurposing. Only credit card and debit card payment is accepted, no cash or checks.
- Local garage/estate sales in Bloomington - keep an eye out as you walk around the neighborhoods. People will put stuff out by the trash or on their front lawn. Often it's obvious that it's free to take.

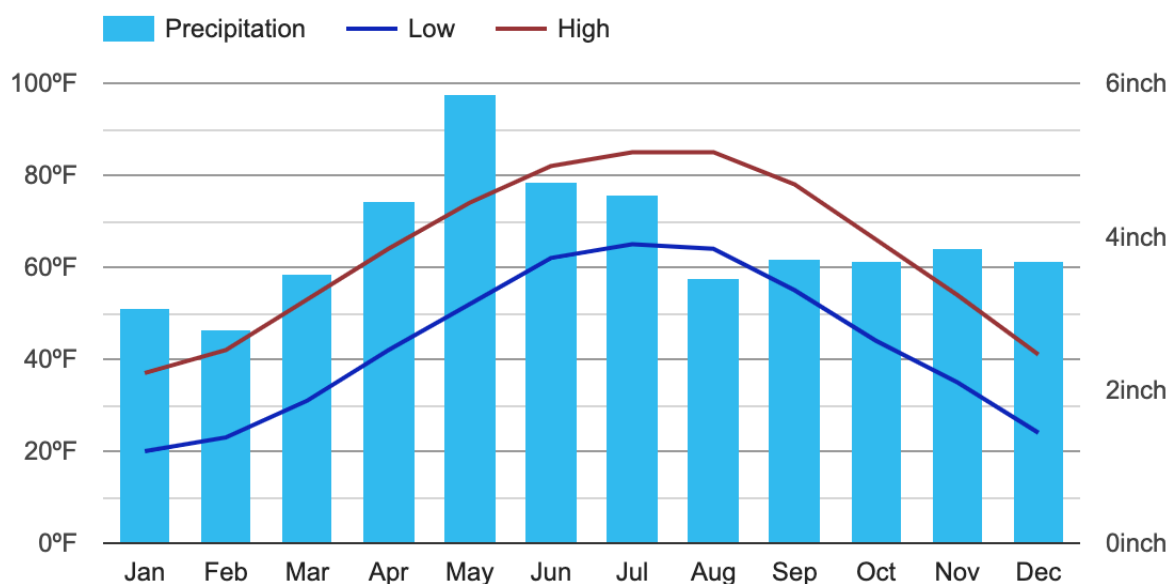
Nearby Shopping Centers with Furniture

- [Target](#): We know most of you will arrive without cars to start. Target is on the bus route, is considered a discount store, has most anything you would need for your home, groceries, a Starbucks in the store, pharmacy, and more.
- [Bed Bath & Beyond](#): This is a more upscale store for home goods, also with a location on the College Mall bus route.
- [College Mall](#): Around 100 stores, on the bus route, where you'll find shoes, clothing, eateries, nail & hair services, jewelry, electronics, and more.
- [Best Buy](#): This large store, within walking distance of the bus route by the Mall, has computers, printers, TVs, stereos, cell phones, and some appliances under one roof.

Local Weather/Climate

- <https://www.usclimatedata.com/climate/bloomington/indiana/united-states/usin0046>

Bloomington Climate Graph - Indiana Climate Chart



- What kind of clothes should you bring/pack?
 - Plan to dress in layers! The weather can vary within as much as 20 degrees in one day, and different buildings and rooms across campus are often kept at different temperatures.

Transportation such as buses, etc.

Traveling from Indianapolis International Airport to Bloomington

- [Go Express Travel](#): Approx. \$29 one way trip
- [Go Airport Shuttle Service](#): Approx. \$50/person one way

Bloomington area bus

- [IU Campus Bus](#): IU Campus Bus (Red and White buses) runs mostly inside campus and it is free to ride for anyone.
- [Bloomington Transit](#): Bloomington Transit (Green and White buses) runs inside as well as surrounding areas outside the campus. In general using Bloomington Transit service requires fare (\$1 per trip) or pass. But students can ride it free because the transportation fee that they pay per semester includes the pass. They only need to show their IU Crimson card to the bus drivers while boarding. Apart from that, children upto 4 years old can also use the bus without any fare.
- [DoubleMap](#): Application to find the live location of buses. It is extremely useful!

Parking

- For more information on parking and permits, visit <https://parking.indiana.edu/>
- IU also has a map where you can locate parking lots on campus.
<https://map.concept3d.com/?id=951#!ce/16640?ct/16650,16651,16652,16653>

Banks

- [IU Credit Union](#): 105 E Winslow Rd, Bloomington, IN 47401. (812) 855-7823
 - Need 2 forms of ID including social security number. Have to make a \$5 deposit upon opening an account.
- [Chase](#): 100 S College Ave, Bloomington, IN 47404. (812) 331-6229
- [First Financial Bank](#): 536 N College Ave, Bloomington, IN 47404. (844) 828-7740
- [Fifth Third Bank](#): 3200 East Third Street, Bloomington, IN 47401. (812) 332-2293
- [German American Bank](#): 504 N College Ave, Bloomington, IN 47404. (812) 355-2265
- [People's State Bank](#): 200 E Kirkwood Ave, Bloomington, IN 47408. (812) 333-2228
- [Old National](#): 2490 S Walnut St, Bloomington, IN 47401. (812) 330-6164

Hospitals and Health Centers

- [IU Health Center](#): The Indiana University Health Center is a four-story facility on the Indiana University Bloomington campus that includes a full-service medical clinic (with walk-in

availability and same day appointments), laboratory, x-ray facility, women's clinic, eye injury clinic, wellness services, immunization and travel clinic, counseling and psychological services, physical therapy, nutrition, a pharmacy, and much more. IU Health Center specializes in care for college-aged patients. Please note that they are not affiliated with the IU Health system.

- [IU Health Bloomington Hospital](#): IU Health currently has visitor restrictions in place for our hospitals and outpatient surgery centers to help minimize the risk of COVID-19
- [IU Health Urgent Care](#): When you need immediate care for a non-life-threatening illness or injury, Indiana University Health Urgent Care in Bloomington can be an option.

Cell Service Providers

Cell phone companies offer two payment models for service—postpaid and prepaid. Postpaid wireless service is the traditional arrangement for a cell phone plan. When signing up, you sign a contract agreeing to pay a certain amount each month for the agreed-upon service. The provider delivers the service to you continuously and bills you each month. Large deposits are usually required, especially for those without Social Security numbers. This deposit is normally refunded at some point (this varies by phone service provider).

All major cell phone providers in the United States offer prepaid wireless plans. When buying prepaid wireless service, a provider makes an agreed-upon number of minutes available to your cell phone, and you pay for those minutes at the time of agreement. Once you have used the minutes you purchased, you need to buy more to be able to keep using your phone continuously. This option does not typically require a credit check or a deposit.

Cell phones purchased in another country can be used in the USA as long as they can be GSM-enabled (Global System for Mobile Communications), and “unlocked” (the SIM card can be removed and replaced and is not tied to a specific carrier).

We recommend using sites like wirefly (<https://www.wirefly.com/>) to research the different options in Bloomington. We also advise you to read the contract carefully before signing it.

Some (but not all) popular wireless carriers:

- AT&T (<https://www.att.com/stores/indiana/bloomington/91950>): Wireless and Internet provider.
- Verizon (<https://www.verizon.com/stores/details/indiana/bloomington/bloomington-350686/>).
- T-Mobile (<https://www.t-mobile.com/store-locator/in/bloomington/>)

Libraries

Libraries: There are several libraries on IU’s campus, which offer services from research assistance, workshops and guides, as well as interlibrary loans. Many of the libraries also have plenty of [desk space](#) and small rooms for quiet study or group meetings.

Monroe County Public Library - downtown Bloomington. Great for renting novels, audio books, and movies.

Technology

UITS: At IU, you will have access to technology—computers, high-speed Internet service (including wireless), free software, and more.

Legal/Language Services

- Free legal help for students at IU:
<https://studentaffairs.indiana.edu/student-support/legal-services/services/index.html>
- Help with taxes
<https://www.law.indiana.edu/student-life/organizations/vita/index.shtml>
- Questions about Visa
<https://ois.iu.edu>

Beware of Scams

Scammers often target international students and scholars across the U.S. They frequently act like government or immigration officials to scare you into giving out money or personal information. If you ever receive a phone call or email asking about your immigration status, personal information, or seeking immediate payment, be suspicious. It is important that you protect your personal information. U.S. government agencies or representatives will not require payment from you over phone or email. All requests for official payments will arrive on government stationery. Our office will always use your IU email for formal communication.

Please go through this link from OIS for more information on typical scams and how to report it:
<https://ois.iu.edu/living-in-the-us/safety/scams.html>

For Families with Children

- Wonderlab Museum of Science, Health & Technology: <https://www.wonderlab.org/>
- Kids Play Gym: <https://kidsplaygym.com/>
- Collaborating for Kids, LLC (Autism Clinic): <https://www.collabforkids.com/>
- **Child Care:** Early Childhood Education Services provides options appropriate for your child on campus and can advise on other services in the community for students with children.
- **Public Library:** In recent years, Bloomington's Monroe County Public Library was chosen as the best in the nation for our town our size. Lots of media for families to enjoy and a full range of programs. Having a public library card also provides access to a lot of free digital media. Make sure you take the [required documents](#) with you to secure a library card.

Additional Resources

- Cowork space in Bloomington: <https://dimensionmill.org/join/>

Holidays

- Chicago is just a 4 hours drive away, a perfect getaway for the holidays.
- Indiana is one of the Great Lakes states. It is bordered on the north by Lake Michigan and the state of Michigan, on the east by Ohio; on the south by Kentucky, with which it shares the Ohio River as a border; and on the west by Illinois. So, a number of neighboring states to explore.
- There are 25 state parks in Indiana. Brown County, the largest state park, has the greatest number of visitors, followed by Indiana Dunes State Park.

Points of Interest Surrounding Bloomington

- Tibetan Mongolian Buddhist Cultural Center: <https://www.tmbcc.org/>
- Hoosier Heights (rock climbing): <https://www.hoosierheightsbloomington.com/>
- Hiking, boating, nature trails, etc.
 - Lake Lemon: <https://www.visitbloomington.com/listing/lake-lemon/113/>
 - Lake Monroe: <https://bloomington.in.gov/locations/lake-monroe>
 - Cascades Park: <https://bloomington.in.gov/parks/parks/lower-cascades>
 - Griffey Lake: <https://bloomington.in.gov/parks/parks/griffey-lake>
- Hinkle-Garton Farmstead/other historic sites: <http://bloomingtonrestorations.org/>
- The Bluebird (live music venue): <https://www.thebluebird.ws/>

Part-Time Jobs

- [African American Arts Institute](#)
- [Career Development Center](#)
- [Cyberinfrastructure for Network Science Center](#)
- [GradGrants Center](#)
- [IU Human Resources](#)
- [IU Libraries](#)
- [IU Orientation Student Jobs](#)
- [Indiana Daily Student](#)
- [Ivy Tech Community College](#)
- [Monroe County Public Library](#)
- [Recreational Sports](#)
- [Student Academic Center Jobs](#)
- [Teaching-IU Collins Living-Learning Center](#)
- [UITS](#)

- [Writing Tutorial Services Jobs](#)

Grant Opportunities

- [IU Foundation](#)
- [Women's Philanthropy Leadership Council Grant](#)
- [Luddy Admissions Scholarships](#)
- [IU Graduate School Scholarships and Fellowships](#)